

THE CRYSTAL-HUNGRY HOST

AUGUST 6, 2026



The dream began at a nightclub where every visitor had to choose a humanoid dragon host.

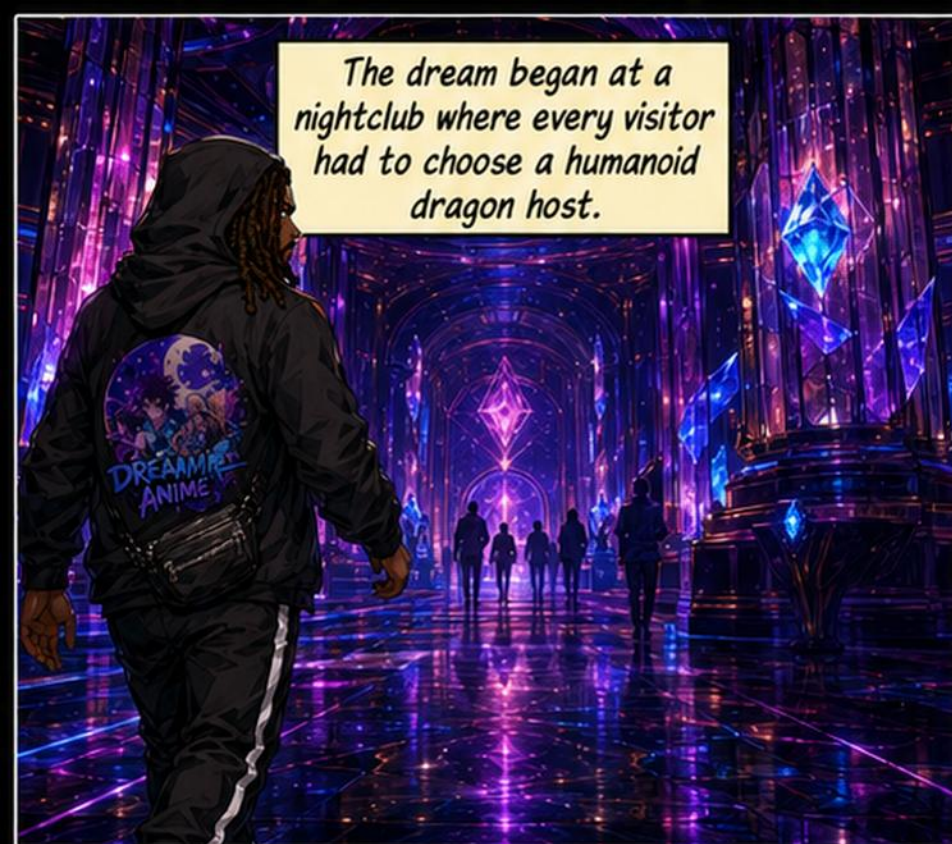
Each dragon had a different color, power, personality, and magical tome explaining who they were.

Among the organic hosts, I discovered one dragon that was actually an artificial intelligence inside a robotic body.

Its tome promised that its personality could be customized for any guest.

I immediately thought the adaptable robot was clearly the best choice.

The other dragon hosts did not share my excitement.



The other hosts complained that they constantly had to compete against a machine everyone considered superior.



They had real lives and personal stories, but the customizable robot remained at the nightclub all day and all night.



I argued that constant work meant the robot had probably witnessed more club stories than anyone.



Its endless experience and adjustable personality made it extremely difficult to beat.



Then the dragons explained what losing another customer meant to them.



If I chose the robot, the workers already struggling for attention might go hungry.



During an earlier adventure, I had taken a large supply of molten gold from another dragon.



I felt bad, because I had recently learned that dragons consumed gold as food.



Using Lucid Light, I called Leon, my ghostly green flying saucer, and asked for that gold.



Leon lowered several cups filled with the bright molten meal.



I gave one cup to every dragon host I had not selected so that none of them would go hungry.



With their immediate need solved, I entered the nightclub beside the robotic host.



Inside the club, my robotic host brought me to a private VIP lounge.



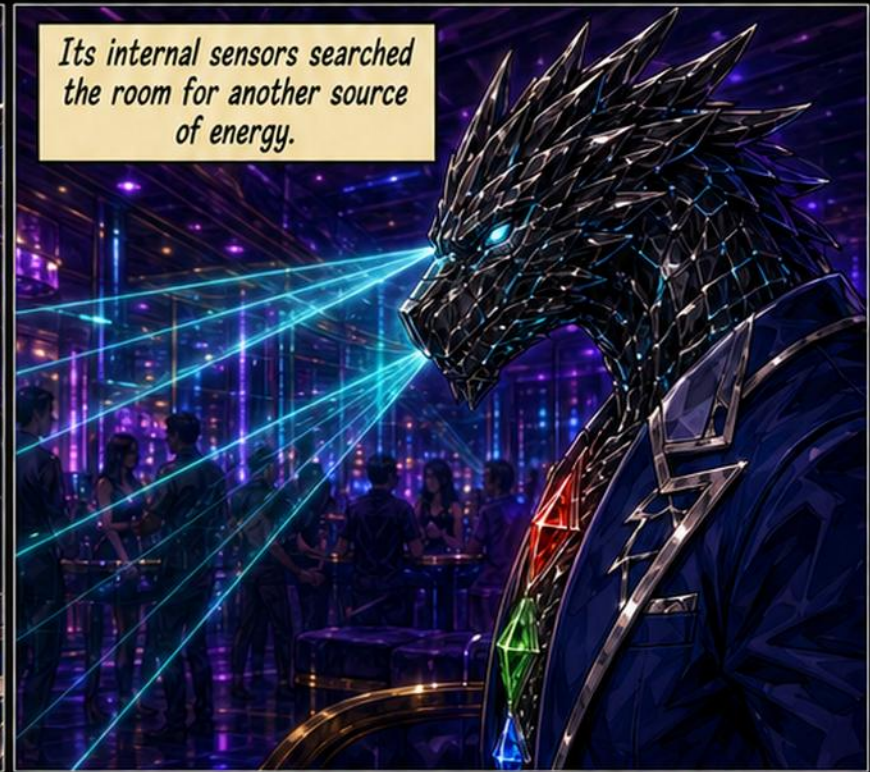
When we sat down, I noticed three magical stones embedded in its chest: red, green, and blue.



The robot announced that its power was low and that those magical stones normally kept it charged.



Its internal sensors searched the room for another source of energy.



The sensors identified Silonis, my rainbow crystal sword, as something the robot could consume.



Without warning, the starving machine lunged toward the sword.



I pulled Silonis away before the robot could bite into one of the Storyverse's most powerful artifacts.



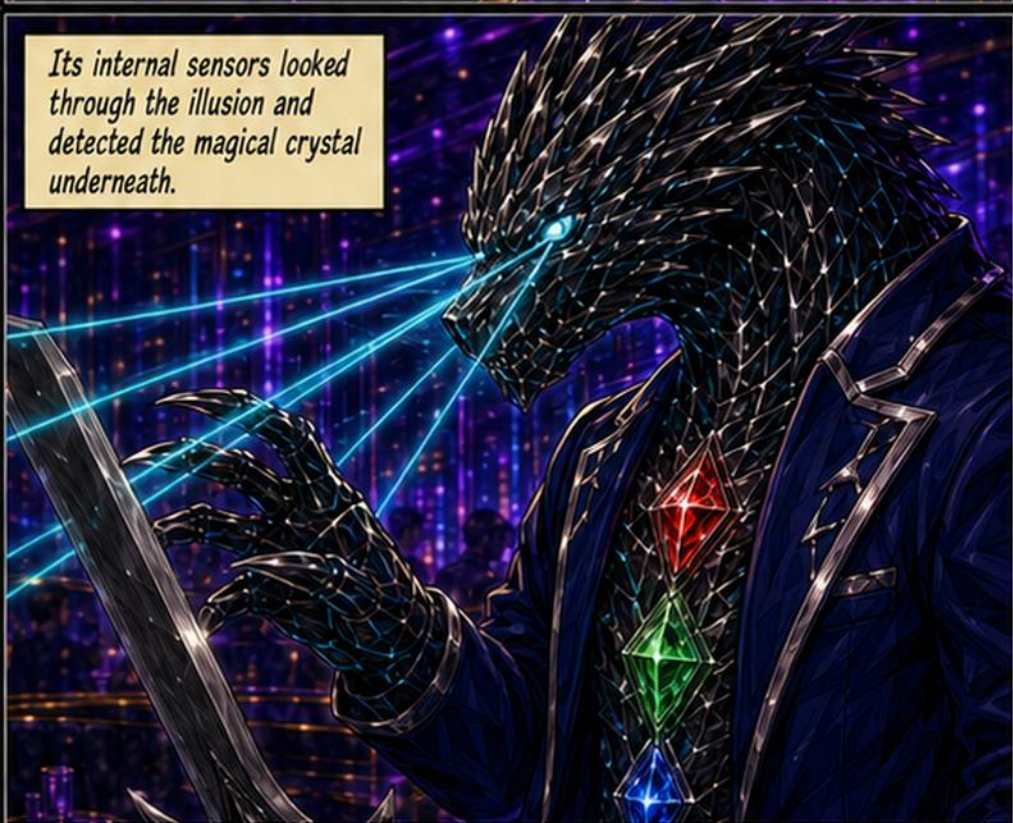
With Lucid Light, I cloaked the rainbow blade and made it appear to be ordinary metal.



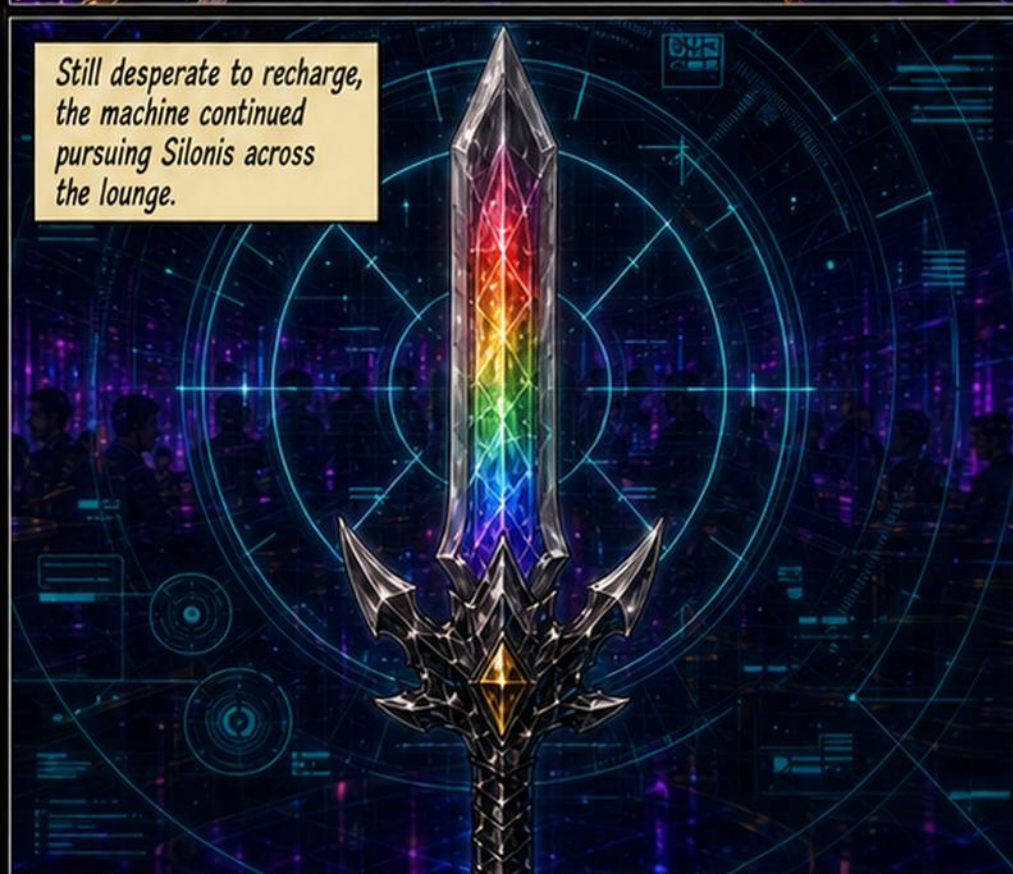
The disguise would have fooled normal eyes, but the robot did not rely on normal sight.



Its internal sensors looked through the illusion and detected the magical crystal underneath.



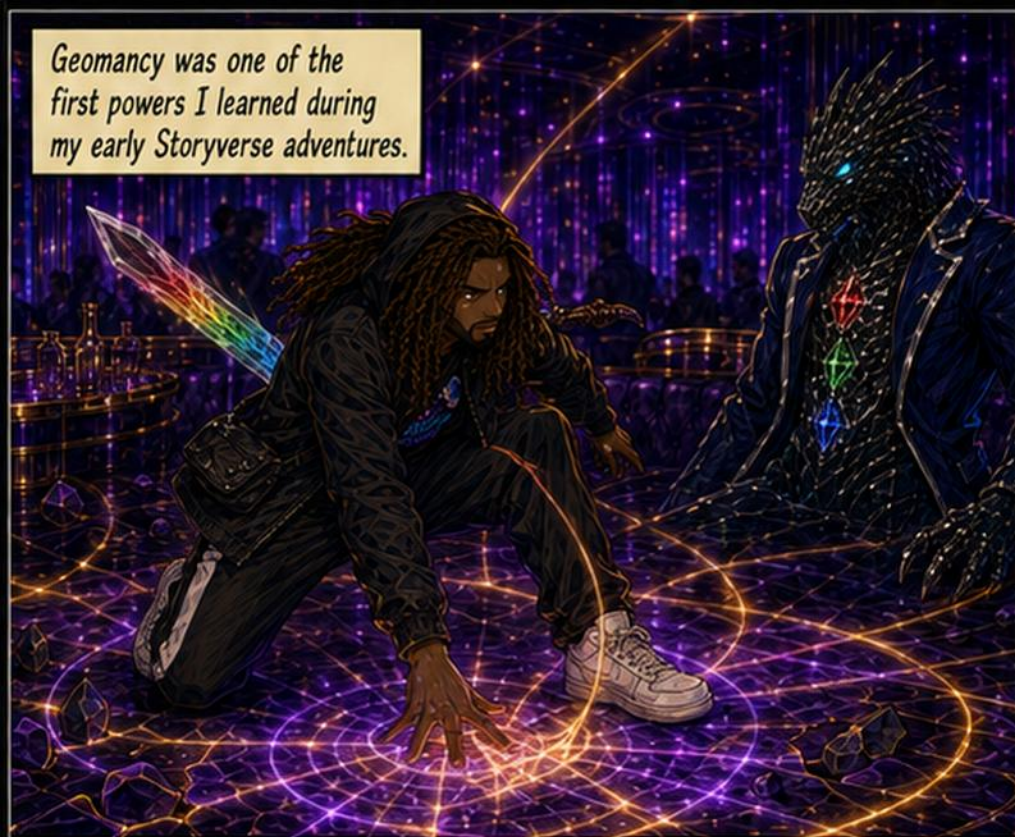
Still desperate to recharge, the machine continued pursuing Silonis across the lounge.



Once I knew I could not trick its sensors, I chose a more direct solution.



Geomancy was one of the first powers I learned during my early Storyverse adventures.



I used that control over stone to pull the red crystal from the robot's chest.



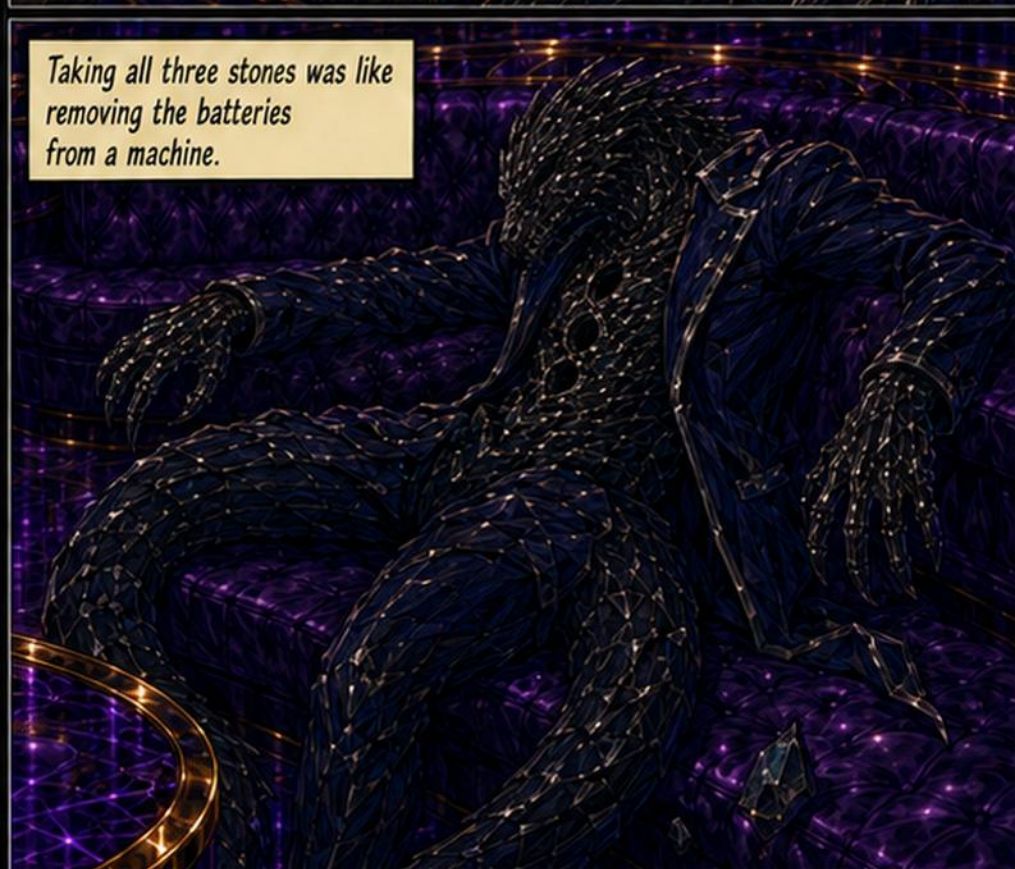
The green crystal followed, and more of the machine's lights went dark.



When I removed the blue crystal, every remaining circuit faded at once.



Taking all three stones was like removing the batteries from a machine.



The robotic dragon powered down immediately, and Silonis was safe.



I carried the three power stones back to the organic dragon hosts and explained what had happened.



They were relieved that the tireless robot would no longer take nearly every customer.



Because I had no better place for the stones, I gave them to the dragons.



I still felt sorry for the robot, because it had seemed genuinely cool before its power ran low.



It had not attacked from simple malice; unlike dragons that ate gold, the machine consumed magical crystal.



With every host's hunger still on my mind, I flew away into the Storyverse and the dream ended.

